Class 7

Naming

Essence

Names are used to denote entities in a distributed system. To operate on an entity, we need to access it at an **access point**. Access points are entities that are named by means of an **address**.

Note

A **location-independent** name for an entity E, is independent of the addresses of the access points offered by E.

Identifiers

Pure Name

A name that has no meaning at all; it is just a random string. Pure names can be used for comparison only.

Identifier: A name having some specific properties

1. An identifier refers to at most one entity.
2. Each entity is referred to by at most one identifier.
3. An identifier always refers to the same entity (i.e. it is never reused).

Observation

An identifier need not necessarily be a pure name, i.e. it may have content.